

ILLUSTRATION BY NILANJAN DAS



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a real problem and moving to urgent action. Here again the role of the private sector, public sector, government and youth is going to be critical. Our present education system is what it is, but it cannot take us to 2047. We need a tsunami of upskilling and uplearning by using the power of the digital and online space that can solve for things at scale and allow each of us who is privileged to be a teacher, mentor, evangelist and inspirer to be involved. We each just need to touch 10 other lives every year and we can reshape our country like no other.

- Yes, we need a DNA change on how to look to be a part of a global economy. Take our long overdue efforts for free trade agreements (FTAs) with most of the world—and we are stuck with the double standards of our industry and leaders—as we seek protectionism, yet free trade and globalisation. This has to get sharp and change.
- Yes, we need an executable blueprint to be a soft power. As perception is an important part of success, so we need to be a soft power in our rich culture, our storytelling, our history and tourism, and our innovation. We want to originate, not duplicate. And we, unlike some of the western powers, want to lead by example, not lead to dominate, as that is the show of real strength and power.

What an incredible time to be alive, kicking, creating, excelling, inspiring, executing as also giving back in India. **BT**

The author is Co-founder of upGrad and Swades Foundation. Views are personal